YANBIN (TRACY) XU

Research Economist | Digital Markets, Innovation & the Economics of AI

Georgetown University • Washington, DC • yx76@georgetown.edu • yanbinxu.com

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Fritz Family Postdoctoral Fellow | Knight–Georgetown Institute (KGI) 2025–Present
Research: digital market competition, effective contestability, innovation incentives, and technology regulation.

EDUCATION

Georgetown University | Ph.D. in Economics 2025
Razin Prize (2025), awarded for the job-market research paper.

Georgetown University | M.A. in International Development Economics 2015

Renmin University of China | B.A. in International Relations 2009

RESEARCH FIELDS

Digital economics and AI; industrial organization and innovation; technology policy and regulation; spatial and development economics.

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL PUBLICATION

Why is household electricity uptake low in Sub-Saharan Africa?
With Moussa P. Blimpo and Agnieszka Postepska · World Development 133 (2020)

WORKING PAPERS

From Market Opening to Innovation: Effective Contestability in Digital Markets
Working paper · September 2026

Beyond Market Concentration: Measuring Contestability in Digital Markets
With Zhiyang Cheng and Amr Yakout · Working paper, July 2026

Internal Migration Restrictions, Aggregate Productivity, and Spatial Growth
Submitted to International Economics Review · Job-market paper · Razin Prize · May 2025

Digital Skills and Labor Market Demand in Central Asia
Working paper · November 2025

SELECTED POLICY RESEARCH AND REPORTS

Comments on the First Review of the Digital Markets Act (2026)
With Fiona Scott Morton et al. · Yale Tobin Center for Economic Policy
Policy analysis of DMA implementation, enforcement, and regulatory effectiveness.

Designing the Technical Committee for the United States v. Google Search Antitrust Remedy: A Blueprint for Effective Implementation (2026)
With Zander Arnao et al. · Knight–Georgetown Institute
Policy report on competition remedies, technical oversight, and compliance monitoring.

Digital Skills for Lifelong Learning (DS4LL), Kyrgyzstan
World Bank · Policy research report · Forthcoming (pending final institutional approval)
Impact evaluation of digital skills training and competency development across 300 schools.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

The Economics of Artificial Intelligence: Market Structure, Innovation, and Welfare
Research in development
Developing economic frameworks to study how AI market structure, access to key inputs, and firms' capabilities affect competition, innovation incentives, and welfare.

High-Speed Rail: Impacts on Mobility Costs and Spatial Reallocation
Research in development
Spatial equilibrium analysis of transportation improvements, migration frictions, labor allocation, and regional productivity.

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND SEMINARS

Internal Migration Restrictions, Aggregate Productivity, and Spatial Growth
May 2026 RCEA International Conference on Economics, Econometrics, and Finance · Madrid, Spain
June 2026 20th International Symposium on Econometric Theory and Applications (SETA) · Tokyo, Japan
June 2026 12th Hong Kong Economic Association Biennial Conference · Macau
August 2026 EEA–ESEM Congress · Dublin, Ireland

Other presentations
2026 · Digital Competition Conference (DCC'26), Georgetown; research poster on digital competition and innovation.
2024 · Annual Macro Meetings at Georgetown; Georgetown Macroeconomics Seminar.
2018 · Mathematics and Science for Sub-Saharan Africa Annual Conference.

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Digital Competition Conference (DCC) | Organizing Team 2025–Present

- Co-organized DCC'26; coordinating DCC'27 with Georgetown KGI, Yale Tobin Center, and Princeton CITP, bringing together researchers, policymakers, regulators, and technologists.
- Coordinate scholarly program development, peer-review processes, conference planning, and policy-panel outreach.

Ad hoc referee | Journal of Competition Law & Economics

TEACHING EXPERIENCE | GEORGETOWN UNIVERSITY

Instructor | Principles of Macroeconomics Summer 2022

Teaching Assistant | International Trade 2022, 2024

Teaching Assistant | Intermediate Macroeconomics 2021, 2023

Teaching Assistant | Intermediate Microeconomics 2020, 2022

Teaching Assistant | Econometrics 2021

PRIOR PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Research Consultant | World Bank, Education Global Practice 2021–2023

Research Analyst | World Bank, Office of the Chief Economist 2016–2019

Research Consultant | World Bank, Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund 2014–2015

Data Analyst | Management Systems International 2014–2015

Summer Research Intern | Innovations for Poverty Action 2014

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2025 Razin Prize, Georgetown University — best graduate research paper.

2019–2025 Georgetown University Ph.D. Fellowship.

2013–2015 Georgetown University Merit-Based Scholarship.

RESEARCH METHODS AND SOFTWARE

Structural and general-equilibrium modeling; applied microeconometrics; impact evaluation; policy evaluation and institutional analysis.

Software: Stata, MATLAB, R, Python, LaTeX.

Languages: Chinese (native), English (professional), French (Intermediate).